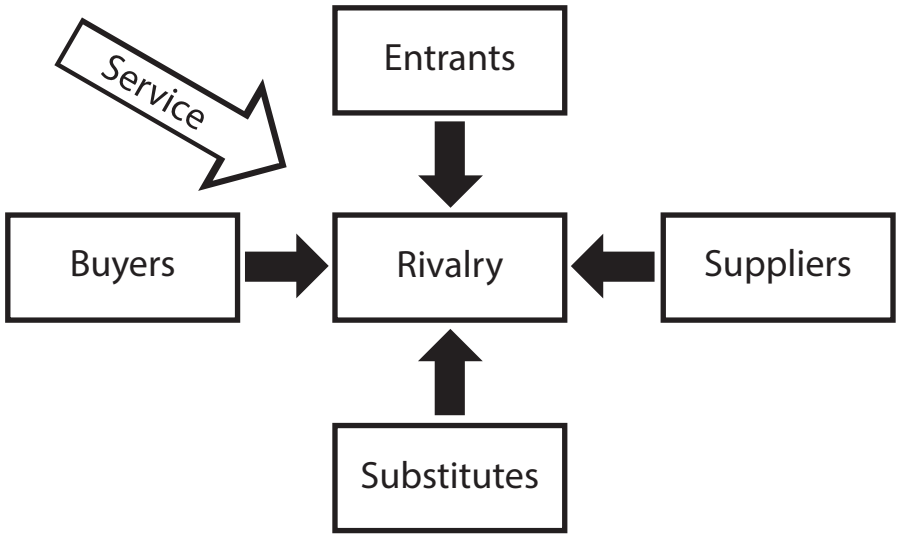
Porter's Five Forces



Substitu

Are there easy substitutes users can fall back on?

What's your user's next best alternative to your product?

Are users actively searching for a solution?

Is there "pull" demand from users?
Are folks actively and publicly asking for a solution? If so, you better listen to what they say.

Suppliers

Are their factors increasing potential users?

Do you believe that demand for your product is increasing because of certain conditions of the market?

Ideally, every startup should be able to answer yes, as this determines whether you believe your market will grow.

Rivalry

Are there competitive services available?

Are there services that folks currently use in lieu of a "perfect" solution?

Are there current services that promise similar value?

Entrants

Do users see lots of new entrants?

If you see a new startup trying to solve the same problem, it's clear many folks feel it and have ideas for how to solve it.